



Create Home Videos Using WMM

Use Windows Movie Maker to cut Oscar winners from your camcorder recordings!

Varun Dubey

So you got yourself a brand new camcorder? And you need to share your videos with family by burning VCDs and distributing them? We get into the nitty-gritty of WMM so you can do just that—rest assured, 30 minutes of familiarisation is all it'll take!

What You'll Need

A camcorder, a TV tuner card if you have an analogue camera, and Windows Movie Maker (WMM), which comes pre-installed with Windows XP. You may want to download WMM2, which is the updated version, from www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/downloads/updates/moviemaker2.msp

Note that WMM2 comes bundled with XP Service Pack 2. The key difference between WMM1 and WMM2 is that WMM2 allows you to burn a CD in the WMV or HighMat formats.

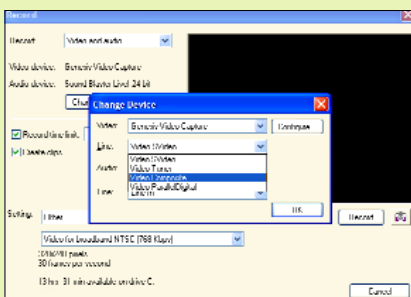
However, HighMat does not enjoy widespread support, so you're better off burning a simple VCD using third-party software such as Nero or Easy CD. The other difference is the added effects. Everything else is essentially the same.

1 Firing Up Movie Maker

To start the program, navigate to **Start > All Programs > Accessories > Windows Movie Maker**.

2 Configuring The Audio/Video Devices

To configure your video



The configuration window for the video device

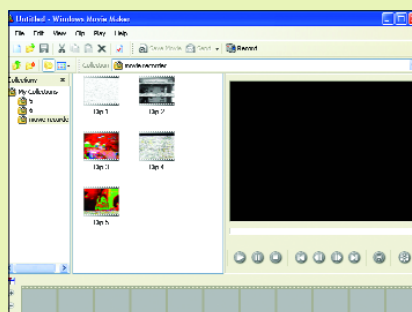
device in the software, you may click 'Change Device', and you will get a configuration window where 'Video:' will show the various video capture devices available (if you have multiple TV tuners or FireWire ports).

In the latter case, you will need to have the camera connected to it, otherwise the FireWire port will not show up.)

Choose the appropriate video and audio devices and the correct line-in settings if you are using a TV tuner (as opposed to a FireWire connection).

3 Encoding

On clicking 'OK', you will return to the previous screen where you can make adjustments to the quality. If after setting the quality to High Quality you are not satisfied,



WMM automatically generates clips for you!

we recommend you click 'other' and select 'Video for broadband NTSC (768Kbps)'.

The automatic clip creation feature works really well. What it essentially does is, it detects scene changes, and saves each scene as a separate video file, or clip, so you need not cut out different video clips or leave too much gap in between the different recordings.

4

Now you need to play the video file on your camcorder (if you connected via an S-Video cable or a regular A/V cable).

In case, you've connected via FireWire, you'll get the controls on the software itself—now you can play and record the movie from there.

5 Once you've got all the contents onto the clip area, and you can see the various clips, you are ready to create your movie. Browse through the various clips and drag and drop the suitable ones onto the timeline area below. The neat thing about the timeline and clipping is that you can entirely change the order of the video!

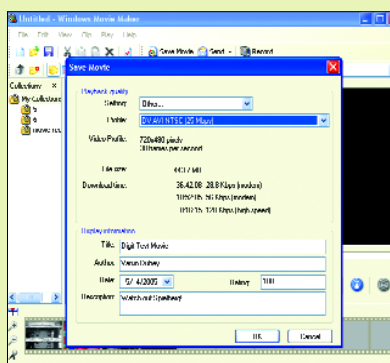
6 After you have the various clips on the timeline, you can, if you want, edit out unrequired stuff from the clips to make the movie crisp and fast-paced.

7 After you've satisfactorily nipped and tucked your movie, you can preview the entire thing by clicking the first clip on the timeline and hitting 'Play' in the preview area.

If all is well and you're happy with the results, you're ready to save the movie file.

8 Click on the 'Save Movie' button on top, and select the proper resolution.

Remember, the higher the resolution, the more time your



Save your movie at the proper resolution

movie will take to save, and obviously, it'll occupy more space.

That's all there is to it, your very own home video is ready! Now just burn a VCD using your favourite burning software, and share all those precious moments!

varun_dubey@thinkdigit.com